



Examination Report

History

6891

EGCSE

2025

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PAPER 6891/01
International Relations

Key messages

- Candidates are reminded that part (a) questions require the recall and development of specific details.
- In part (b) questions candidates should identify the factors and then support them with specific relevant evidence. The evidence should be elaborated in relation to the question.
- Teachers and candidates are reminded about the importance of the skill of evaluation in part (c). The skill carries a reserved grade of two (2) marks which translates to a total of six (6) marks.
- Teachers are encouraged to explain historical terms in History e.g. most failed to understand Humanitarian in question 2 (b).
- Candidates are reminded to write all responses only in the spaces provided.

General comments

Candidates demonstrated a general understanding of the demands of the questions, however, most candidates lacked the relevant content to respond to the questions. Most candidates were able to utilise the spaces provided to answer questions, some created additional spaces to write the responses of the parts (b) and (c). A majority of candidates were able to follow instructions for choosing and answering questions, few candidates attempted more than the stipulated number of questions while others attempted less than the stipulated number of questions. Thus candidates are advised to adhere to the instructions.

Comments on Specific Questions

International Relations, 1919-c.1989

Question 1

Most candidates attempted this question, however, most candidates struggled to provide the relevant content to respond to part (c) question. Most candidates provided one-sided argument for the part (c) question.

- (a) This part question required candidates to **describe three economic benefits that the French obtained at the Treaty of Versailles**. Most candidates were unable to recall specific content to respond to the question. Most candidates lacked specific details as they turned out to be general. For instance, they were able to give specific identifications such as Alsace-Lorraine but failed to develop them.

An example of a response showing identification and development:

France obtained the coal mines of the Saarland. France obtained raw materials from African colonies. France gained reparations from Germany to repair the damaged infrastructure.

- (b) This part question required candidates to **explain two reasons why the British did not support the French demands at the Treaty of Versailles**. Candidates were able to provide proper explanations.

A model answer showing the two explanations:

The British wanted to trade with Germany. Germany was Britain's largest trading partner before the war, therefore, the British did not support crippling Germany in order to resume the trade ties.

The British did not want Germany to seek revenge. France wanted Germany to be crippled yet Britain believed that the Germans would recover and cause another war in the future.

- (c) **Candidates were required to evaluate whether Germany's reaction towards the occupation of the Ruhr by French and Belgian troops was justified.**

This was a poorly done part question because candidates could not justify Germany's reaction towards the occupation of the Ruhr. Some candidates mistook the Ruhr for the Rhineland.

A model answer showing the two sides of the argument with an evaluation:

I agree with the statement that Germany's reaction towards the occupation of the Ruhr by the French and Belgian troops was justified because the French and Belgians had entered German territory. This was humiliating to the country to have armies of other countries forcefully taking goods, therefore, the Germans were justified in getting angry at them.

However, it was not justified because reparations were part of the terms of the Treaty of Versailles. The Germans had committed themselves that they would pay the reparations and if not a value of the reparations would be taken in goods. So there was no reason for the workers to strike, instead government should have encouraged workers to produce more goods.

Evaluation: *In conclusion taking goods equivalent to the value of reparations was legal according to the Treaty of Versailles hence Germany's reaction was not justified even though it humiliated them.*

Question 2

This was a popular question even though most candidates could not provide accurate content to respond to the part (a) and (c) questions. As a result, the performance in this question was below average. Candidates often used irrelevant content to respond to the questions.

This part question required candidates to describe three features of the Greek-Bulgarian crisis of **1925**. Most candidates provided general responses that lacked specific features of the Greek-Bulgarian crisis.

An example of a response showing identification and development:

Greece invaded Bulgaria to avenge the death of Greek troops. This was reported to the League of Nations which convened a meeting. Greece was told to pay compensation even though they complained.

- (a) This part question required candidates to **explain two reasons why the League of Nations failed to solve the Vilna crisis of 1920**. Most candidates were only able to explain one reason while others gave general failures of the League of Nations.

A model answer showing the two explanations:

The Poles had a genuine claim on Vilna as the city had 30% Poles and only 2% Lithuanians and according to the League, the Poles deserved self-determination. It was the self-interest of leading members because France did not want to upset the Poles by forcing them out of Vilna as they saw Poland a possible ally with Germany while Britain did not want to act alone.

- (b) Candidates were required to evaluate **whether the League was only able to solve humanitarian problems in the 1920's**. Candidates had the challenge of understanding the term humanitarian as a result they ended up giving general failures of the League of Nations.

A model answer showing the two sides of the argument with an evaluation:

I agree with the statement because the League was able to solve labour issues by limiting the number of hours small children were allowed to work. This was the humanitarian work of the League.

However, some historians may disagree because the League was able to solve the Aaland Island problem. It awarded the islands to Finland and Sweden accepted the decision which was an important political success of the League.

EVALUATION: Despite the success of the League in solving political problems such as the Aaland Islands it is important to note that the League also solved social problems that could lead to war.

Question 3

This question was also popular. Candidates who attempted the question performed relatively well.

- (a) This part question required candidates **to describe three ways in which the USA contributed to the Bay of Pigs incident**. A majority of the candidates were unable to provide fully developed descriptions as they narrated the incident of the Bay of Pigs instead of the contribution of the USA in the incident.

A model answer showing the description of the involvement of the USA in the incident

The USA harbored the Cuban exiles who went back to Cuba. It provided military training for the exiles at Guatemala. It supplied arms like guns ammunition.

- (b) This part question required candidates **to explain two reasons why the Soviet Union placed Missiles in Cuba**. This was a well performed part question as candidates were able to give detailed explanations.

Model answer showing the two explanations:

The Soviet Union wanted to test the USA. They wanted to see how the USA under President Kennedy would react to the placement of the missiles. To defend Cuba, who had just survived a USA sponsored attack on the Bay of Pigs. So, placing the missiles would prevent the overthrow of Communist Castro.

- (c) Candidates were required to **evaluate whether it was only Khrushchev who acted responsible to avoid war in the Cuban Missile Crisis**.

Candidates had a challenge as on the agreeing side as they explained the part played by both Khrushchev and Kennedy in the crisis instead of showing the role played by Khrushchev only and explain the role played by Kennedy on the other side.

A model answer showing the two sides of the argument with an evaluation:

I agree with the statement because Khrushchev decided to turn the Soviet ships carrying missiles back home after the USA had blockaded Cuba. Had the ships continued to Cuba, war would have started.

However, it was Kennedy who refused to allow the USA to attack Cuba after the U-2 plane incident. This attacked would have forced the USSR to defend Cuba then a war would break out.

EVALUATION: Both Khrushchev and Kennedy acted responsibly as their reaction prevented the war. However, Kennedy's refusal to allow USA to attack after the U-2 plane incident which was a direct attack to them showed total restraint towards the outbreak of a war.

Question 4

- (a) This part question required candidates to **describe three demands made by workers in the 1980 Polish strikes**. Candidates lacked specific details on the demands made by Polish workers as they gave general answers such as, they demanded salary review.

A model answer showing identification and development:

It demanded more pay as people could not cope with the high inflation. They also demanded the reduction of working hours to 48 hour per week (8 hours per day). They also demanded the freedom of speech and press such as an independent media and broadcasting of Catholic Church services.

- (b) This part question required candidates to **explain two reasons why the Polish government found it difficult to suppress Solidarity**. Most candidates were able to identify points but failed to give proper explanations as some used the same evidence to explain both points.

A model answer showing the two explanations:

Solidarity had the support of the Catholic Church to which almost all Poles belonged and the Pope was from Poland, so using violence against Solidarity would bring international criticism. Solidarity was immensely popular. This is because it was supported by many Poles including Communists who exposed the weaknesses of the Communist Government. So this made it difficult for the government to be hard on Solidarity.

- (c) Candidates were required to **evaluate whether it was Gorbachev's policies that led to the collapse of Communism in Eastern Europe**. Very few candidates were able to provide two-sided arguments and a proper evaluation of this question. This led to candidates attaining lower marks in this question. Some candidates were able to identify Gorbachev's policies but failed to give proper explanations.

A model answer showing the two sides of the argument with an evaluation:

I agree that it was Gorbachev's policies like Perestroika and glasnost as they relaxed Communist control over the people and they started to demand more autonomy. This eventually contributed to the collapse of Communism.

However, it was Solidarity's victory in the 1989 Polish elections that inspired other Organisation in other Soviet satellite states to rebellion against Communism, overthrowing all USSR linked regimes by the end of 1989.

Evaluation: Although Gorbachev's policies contributed to the collapse of Communism, it was the victory that Solidarity had in the 1989 elections which influenced other countries to rebel against USSR linked regimes as Solidarity was popular not only within the Soviet Union but also outside.

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PAPER 6891/02

Depth Study

Key messages

The paper comprises of six (6) source-based questions. The candidates in this paper are expected to answer all the questions. Total marks allocated for the paper is fifty (50) marks.

The following aspects are crucial when preparing for this paper.

- The ability to interpret sources is a critical skill that candidates must possess in order to effectively answer questions on this paper. Teachers are therefore urged to help candidates learn the skill of source interpretation.
- Teachers and candidates are reminded to pay attention to the demands of the questions, particularly where they are required to either utilise information from the sources and/or contextual knowledge in answering the questions.
- Candidates are further encouraged to refer to sources by name (e.g. Source A...) when answering questions.
- Teachers are encouraged to assist candidates to cover content on the depth study, as some candidates ended up using content from other topics in answering the questions.

For example, instead of sticking to the economic boom some learners wrote about the new deal and prohibition.

General comments

Candidates demonstrated a general understanding of the demands of the questions. Most candidates were able to provide responses to all the questions in the paper, a very limited number of candidates left questions unanswered. Candidates were also able to use the spaces provided to answer questions, very few candidates created additional spaces.

Few candidates were able to interpret sources at big message level and apply them to their responses. Therefore, most candidates were unable to receive the full number of marks allocated for the question because they frequently used the sources' details rather than the points of view to support their arguments. Candidates also struggled to provide high quality responses on questions that required them to utilize two sources, for example, questions two (2) and four (4).

Comments on Specific Questions

Question 1

This question required candidates to **interpret the big message of Source A**, select relevant evidence from the source to support the big message and provide an elaboration. Most candidates were only able to provide sub-messages, while others described the details of the cartoon when answering the question. None of the candidates had the ability to interpret Source A for its big message.

A model message of the source:

The message of Source A is that the American president/Republicans believed that the USA economy was doing well in the 1920s. This is because in the source president Coolidge who is shown as a medical doctor is checking the health condition of his patient America and is smiling, meaning that he is happy with the condition of the American economy.

Question 2

This question required candidates to interpret Sources B and C for big messages, **compare these two big messages for agreement and disagreement at the point of view level**. Candidates were then expected to select the relevant evidence from Sources B and C to support agreement and disagreement. A considerable number of candidates were able to compare the sources at point of view or big message level for agreement. Most candidates were only able to compare the sources at sub-message level or details.

A model response showing comparison:

Source B and Source C agree that the motor vehicle industry contributed to the American economic boom. This is because source B says the motor vehicle itself stimulated a number of allied industries and source C says by far the motor vehicle industry itself drove the American economy in the 1920s.

They differ about the other factors which caused the American economic boom apart from the motor vehicle industry. Source B describes other factors like the influence of the First World War and Republican policies, whereas source C says the motor vehicle industry was the main factor which led to the economic boom.

Question 3

Candidates were required to interpret the big message of Sources D, **find the purpose and determine the usefulness of the source based on the purpose**. Few candidates were able to meet the demands of this question as they only managed to use details or sub messages of the sources to answer the question. Most candidates were unable to use the big message to establish the purpose of the source which would then be used to explain the usefulness of the source.

A model response showing usefulness of source D based on the purpose of the big message:

Source D is useful in showing us that Americans criticised the Republican government for ignoring the farming sector in favour of the industrial economy during the boom. This is evident in the source as it shows farmers struggling yet the industries were enjoying prosperity and the government is not helping.

Question 4

This question required candidates to make **a cross-reference between Source E and F based on purposes and contextual knowledge of both sources to explain why they are not surprised by these sources**. This involves candidates interpreting the sources for big messages, establishing their contexts and purposes before explaining why they are not surprised. A majority of candidates were only able to make arguments based on sub-messages and details of the sources, others failed to cross reference the sources which made them attain low marks.

A model response showing cross-referencing explaining why not surprised by Source F:

I am not surprised by hoovers account in E in view of Source F because both sources were produced to campaign for votes in the USA in the 1928 elections. As source E was produced by the Republicans to convince the Americans to vote for them in the upcoming elections of 1928 while source F was produced by the Democratic party to de-campaign the Republicans at the time of elections.

Question 5

This question required candidates to **explain the purpose of publishing Source G in the context of the 1920s in the USA**. This demanded that the candidate interpret the big message of Source G and then find its purpose with a clear statement on the intended impact of the source on the audience. Most candidates were able to interpret the source at sub message level or just giving details from the source. However, they struggled to explain the purpose of the source based on the context of the period of the source. The performance of most candidates in this question was below average.

A model response showing the purpose of Source G in the context of the 1930s:

Source G was published to discourage the American society from supporting the USA/ Republican government's economic policies. This is because the policies that were introduced by the Republicans created social problems such as crime and gangsterism. The source also shows a neglected child celebrating crime while the man representing USA is cuddling the financial child.

Question 6

The question required learners to **evaluate the sources as whether they proved that USA was prosperous in the 1920s**. This question required candidates to synthesise the sources based on a given statement. The question also required candidates to make an assertion, select appropriate evidence,

explain the evidence according to the statement and evaluate at least two sources for biasness.

Candidates performed above average in this question as they were able to provide arguments on both sides. However, some candidates did not make assertions, combined the sources and wrote essays which made them to score low marks. Few candidates were able to evaluate the minimum two sources for biasness.

A model response on synthesis:

Source A proves that USA was prosperous. The source shows the American President who is shown as a medical doctor checking the health condition of his patient America and is happy with the condition of the American economy. This proves that America was prosperous. However, source A is propaganda used by the Republican government to convince the American society that it was bringing prosperity.

Source B proves that USA was prosperous because it says American economy began to expand due to Republican policies which lowered income tax rates in 1926 and 1928, this, left people with more cash to spend on American goods thus proving that USA was prosperous.

Source C proves that USA was prosperous as it tells that there was an increase in employment by mentioning that the motor industry was employing hundreds of thousands of workers.

Source D proves that USA was prosperous as it shows industries in the West doing well as the source shows us a child sleeping on a bed of prosperity which proves that the USA was prosperous. However, the source also does not prove because it shows farmers struggling with high cost of living shouting for help which shows that the country was not prosperous.

Source D proves that the USA was prosperous as it was published to criticize the Republican government for ignoring the farming sector in favour of the industrial economy during the boom.

Source E proves that the USA was prosperous as Hoover is saying the USA is nearer to the final triumph over poverty than ever before in the history of any land. However, this source was used by Hoover as propaganda to campaign for votes.

Source F does not prove that the USA was prosperous as it shows a donkey representing the democrats mocking prosperity, saying prosperity!! blah blah blah!! Which means that there was no prosperity in the USA. However, this is a propaganda used by the Democrats to de-campaign the Republicans by saying there was no prosperity.

Source G proves that the USA was prosperous because the source shows uncle Sam cuddling the financial child and feeding her prosperity. Source G also does not prove as it shows a neglected child committing crime which shows that there was a high crime rate in the USA thus it was not prosperous.

Paper 6891/03 Aspects of the History of Southern Africa

Key messages

- The paper comprises of two (2) sections, with the first section being two questions on Swaziland and the other being two questions on South Africa.
- Candidates are expected to answer two questions, one from each section. Total marks allocated for the paper is fifty (50) marks.
- The part (a) questions require candidates to **Give an account/Write an account** where they must give a thorough detailed description of four factors of what is required by the question
- The part (b) questions require candidates to **Discuss** where they must give a thorough, structured, well developed argument and detailed response (two reasons).
- The part (c) questions require candidates to **Evaluate** where candidates must provide two arguments that are developed through relevant evidence demonstrating an extensive and highly accurate knowledge and understanding of the subject. There should be detailed explanation of evidence that is elaborated. The arguments should be evaluated without bringing in new information showing which one is more important than the other.
- Candidates must understand that the questions are quantified e.g. in part (b) there are two reasons to be discussed.
- Candidates should consider the period given in the question to avoid giving irrelevant information which results in loss of marks.
- Educators are urged to expose candidates to historical terms e.g. Commonwealth.
- It is important that educators consider varying the terms used in History e.g. minority rule / Nationalist government / white rule / apartheid government.

General comments

- Generally, the performance was more or less the same as 2024, however it is noted with concern that the number of candidates who gets lower marks is rising.
- Several candidates committed rubric infringement and those candidates did not perform well.
- Most candidates were able to write in the spaces provided which is commended.
- Although several candidates demonstrated an understanding of the skill of writing an account and discussion, it was noted with great concern that they lacked the relevant content resulting in loss of marks.

- Most candidates are still unable to evaluate hence teachers are encouraged to assist them on how to evaluate their arguments.
- Most candidates did not take into consideration the period given in the questions which resulted in loss of marks.
- Candidates tend to ignore the given factor in part (c) and came up with completely new information.
- Instead of arguing with another factor in part (c), candidates tried to find something negative about the given factor which resulted in loss of marks e.g. in question 2 (c) several candidates did not argue with another factor but resorted to looking at how the OVC fund is unable to meet the needs of learners it cater for.

Comments on specific questions

Section A: The Kingdom of Eswatini 1945-c. 2015

Question 1

This was a popular question and most candidates who attempted it did well.

- (a) This part of the question required candidates to **give an account of the aims of the Imbokodvo National Movement (INM) when it was established**. Most candidates were able to give an account of the aims of INM while some candidates were explaining why INM was successful.

An example of a correct answer:

Imbokodvo National Movement wanted to establish a non-racial society that was a racially infusive society which would be open to both blacks and whites.

- (c) This part of the question required candidates to discuss the effect the intensification of the apartheid system of South Africa had on Swaziland. This question was fairly done. Those who did not do well described the features of the British rule.

An example of a correct answer:

The intensification of apartheid in South Africa resulted in the loss of land for Swazis. The South Africans were hiding in Swaziland and some ended up settling in Swaziland permanently. In the process land belonging to Swazis for their future use was lost.

- (c) This part of the question required candidates **to evaluate the significance of the removal of South Africa from the Commonwealth Organisation in the non-incorporation of Swaziland into South Africa**. This question was poorly done. Most of the candidates seemed not to understand the Commonwealth. Candidates assumed the question needed the relationship between Swaziland and

South Africa hence they explained the relationship between Swaziland and South Africa during apartheid period in South Africa.

An example of a correct answer:

The Commonwealth organisation in 1960, expelled South Africa because of her adamant and continued practice of racial discrimination through her formal introduction of Apartheid. So, it became very difficult for Britain, the chairperson of the Commonwealth, to incorporate one of her members to the expelled South Africa.

However, Swaziland was under British rule and they had an economic interest in the country. From 1903, many British citizens came into the country and opened businesses. These included the Havelock asbestos mine in 1939, coal mine at Mpaka and the Ngwenya Iron Ore. Thus, Britain could not allow Swaziland to be incorporated into South Africa as that would rob Britain of the finances she got from Swazi economy.

The removal of South Africa from the Commonwealth was significant in the non-incorporation of Swaziland into South Africa as it served British interest in securing her economy through the businesses owned by British citizens because if Swaziland was incorporated then the Boers were going to ruin their economic take-over their businesses. So, it was important to force South Africa out of the Commonwealth together with the threat of apartheid in order to secure British interests.

Question 2

This was not a popular question and it was poorly done.

- (a) This part of the question required candidates **to give an account of the Tinkhundla system of government as modified by the Establishment of Parliament of Swaziland Order, 1992.**

Candidates gave an account of the Tinkhundla system as introduced by King Sobhuza II in 1978 instead of Tinkhundla as modified by the Establishment of Parliament of Swaziland Order, 1992. **An example of a correct answer:**

Under the Tinkhundla system, registration of votes takes place a few months before nomination of candidates in the different imiphakatsi. Persons of age 18 and above are registered on the voter's roll.

- (b) This part of the question required candidates to **discuss social challenges brought by industries in Swaziland since 1968.** This question was well answered.

An example of a correct answer:

Industries have led to an increase in crime rate. Swazis move to industrial areas and do not get jobs. They then resort to criminal activities.

- (c) This part of the question required candidates **to evaluate the importance of the Orphaned and Vulnerable Children Education Fund in improving the education of Swazis**. Most of the candidates confused the OVCF with FPE. Some candidates showed lack of knowledge on its role in improving education in Swaziland.

An example of a correct answer:

The OVC fund has led to an increase in the number of orphaned and vulnerable Swazi children attending school. More Swazi children who were unable to access education due to lack of funds were able to enroll in the school system after the establishment of the fund.

However, the provision of Free Primary Education (FPE) meant that government paid school fees and provided learning materials for all learners. The free access to primary education eliminated barriers to education such as poverty and unemployment.

The OVC fund has been important in improving the education of Swazis as it gave orphaned and vulnerable children access to Secondary education while the Free Primary Education only paid school fees for learners at Primary school. If it was not for the OVC fund a high number of learners would only study up to the end of Primary level which would not improve the level of education that much.

Section B: South Africa, 1948-c. 1995

Question 3

This was not a popular question and it was poorly done.

- (a) This part of the question required candidates to **give an account of the aims of the Pan African Congress (PAC)**. Most candidates failed to give the aims but generalized on the activities of all the opposition parties. Some even used the apartheid laws to describe the activities.

An example of a correct answer:

The Pan African Congress wanted to oppose the sympathetic spirit of the ANC which accepted Whites, Indians and Coloureds into the ANC. They believed that Africans should stand alone in the struggle against apartheid.

- (d) This part of the question required candidates to **discuss why the Black Consciousness Movement (BCM) was formed**. Most candidates used general responses as they discuss activities of the opposition parties found in South Africa.

An example of a correct answer:

The BCM was established to promote black pride. The apartheid government promoted the policy of white superiority, therefore BCM wanted non-whites to be confident in themselves and their society.

- (e) This part of the question required candidates to **evaluate the significance of the Defiance Campaign of 1952 in opposing minority rule in South Africa in the 1950s**. Most candidates discussed Anti-Pass demonstrations, some even ignore the other side and used events beyond 1950s e.g SOWETO uprisings and Sharpville Massacre.

An example of a correct answer:

The Defiance Campaign was significant in that the mass imprisonment during the campaign overwhelmed the minority government. This was because it undermined the strength of jails as means to punish protesting non-whites. The campaign further gave confidence to the opponents of the government that further mass action protest could bring political changes.

However, the Federation of South African Women organised an anti-pass demonstration in 1956. The success of the demonstration challenged the stereotypes about women and their lack of political drive which was important in the later anti-apartheid activities.

Although the Federation of South Africa Women was significant in opposing minority rule in South Africa, the Defiance campaign paved way for the FSAW in giving them strength/confidence to face the wrath of the minority government when they demonstrated against the carrying of passes, even risking arrest.

Question 4

This was a popular question, however it was poorly done.

- (a) This part of the question required candidates to **give an account of the factors that led to the survival of apartheid in South Africa**. Most candidates gave an account of the apartheid laws and all the repressive methods.

An example of a correct answer:

South Africa had a well-trained and well-equipped armed force. Apartheid spent huge monies on its forces. South Africa had by far the strongest army and air force in the region.

- (b) This part of the question required candidates to **discuss reasons why violence increased in South Africa in the early 1990s**. Most candidates missed the periodization of this question as they discussed violence in general and not the 1990s violence.

An example of a correct answer:

Whites were against one-man one-vote as they were aware that the blacks were a majority. A one-man one-vote would result in blacks winning the majority in elections. Thus, the whites were fighting for race representation in the proposed government.

- (c) This part of the question required candidates to **evaluate the importance of the increase of crime in the decline of the economy of South Africa after 1994**. Some candidates would bring problems faced by the new government instead of the reasons for the decline of the economy. They failed to associate the increase of crime with the decline of the economy of South Africa after 1994.

An example of a correct answer:

The high levels of crime in South Africa led to investors to abandon South Africa. Many multinational companies left South Africa after the crime rate in South Africa increased in the period after 1994. This led to the economy of the country to experience a low growth rate.

However, HIV/AIDS killed the economically active group of the population. Educated people were 2 infected with the diseases. They became less productive which led to the decline in the economic growth rate.

High level of crime rate was indeed important in the decline of the economy of South Africa after 1994 as it led to companies which were important in raising the economy leaving the country.

Even if HIV/AIDS was not killing economically active people, without big companies to run the economy it was still going to suffer without these companies.

